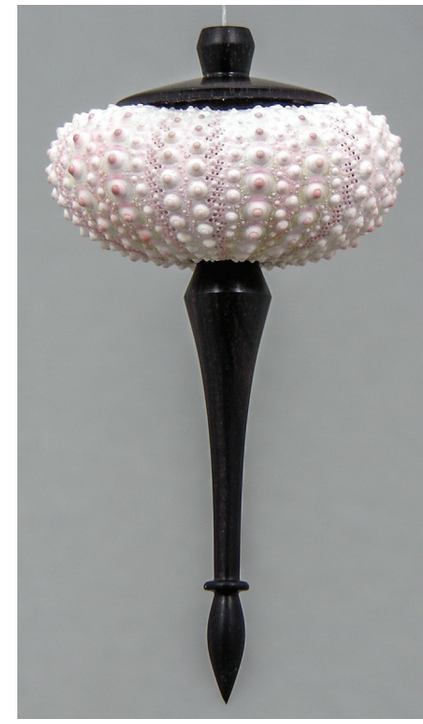
The body, pierced or painted, can feature your finials as delicate spindle turnings

If you intend to turn thin, resembling melting icicles for example, straight grain dense wood is critical



Mini urchin shells, available in green, pink, violet and more, can make a simple but pleasing ornament

Standing ornaments

The beauty of standing shell ornaments is that they need not be 'delicate' or lightweight. Since they won't be hanging, you won't be stressed with the strength of the fishline used for hanging or having the tree leaning over. You also have the luxury of creating a stand of your desire rather than the hanging stand apparatus, normally made of gold wire. Another advantage of the standing ornament is the year-round display potential. While you can use hanging ornaments all year, they tend to be displayed most often during the festive season. Standing ornaments can be displayed on desks, bookshelves, mantles, display cases and more. You can use nearly any shell and any colour scheme you wish to set off your standing ornament. I find that goblets, even with piercing, are an eye catcher. The bonding mechanism becomes far more forgiving. Of course you want the shell bonded to the base but because there will be no weight loading on the bond, you only need to hold it in place. I use the same mentality of trying to conform the nesting in the base to the contour of the shell. A small amount of adhesive in the centre will suffice to keep the shell in place with virtually no dissimilar stressing of the bond. Also, the bond areas are very small so there isn't the type of movement that occurs in furniture and other objects.

The standing ornament lends itself to non-traditional work such as this pierced and painted goblet

Additional desktop-type standing ornament ideas using very simply turned stands

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